John Martinelli

CONTACT

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London, United Kingdom

CAPABILITIES

PRODUCTION & DELIVERY

- End-to-End Project Lifecycle
- Multi-Disciplinary Team Leadership
- Budget Management & Forecasting
- Client & Stakeholder Reporting
- Studio & Operations Management

CREATIVE & DIGITAL

- Digital Branding & Web Builds
- CMS Strategy & Integration
- XR Production — VR / AR / MR
- Brand Activations & Live Events
- Interactive & Digital Experiences

AI & INNOVATION

- Generative AI — Image, Video & Voice
- AI Workflow & Pipeline Automation
- LLM Integration & Prompt Engineering
- Emerging Technology Evaluation

EDUCATION

BA (Hons) Communication, Broadcasting Sound Design
Ravensbourne College of Design
2011

Foundation Degree, Creative Sound Design
Ravensbourne College of Design
2010

PRESS

"Meet the Technologists: John Martinelli" — LBBonline

"The Good, the Bad and the Ugly in the Digital Landscape" — LBBonline

PROFILE

Head of Production and Creative Producer with over 15 years' experience delivering brand experiences, interactive installations, digital products, and live events for global clients. Skilled at leading multi-disciplinary teams, managing complex workflows, and bringing ambitious creative projects to life — on time, on budget, and to a high standard. Comfortable operating at a strategic level while remaining hands-on across production, client relationships, and emerging technology.

WORK HISTORY

Production & Digital Lead — FREELANCE
2025 — 2026
Athlon · London

- Led rebranding and full website rebuild projects for top-tier clients, overseeing creative direction, technical delivery, and stakeholder sign-off throughout.
- Managed long-term technical retainers across enterprise CMS platforms, ensuring quality, uptime, and continuous development of live digital properties.
- Acted as the primary production lead across concurrent workstreams, bridging client services, design, and development teams.

Co-Founder & Head of Production
2019 — 2025
Solarflare Studio · London

- Co-founded and grew a creative technology studio delivering immersive brand experiences, interactive installations, and AI-powered digital products for clients including ASICS, Formula 1, Nike, LEGO, UEFA, Google, Heineken, and Wasserman.
- Oversaw all production operations — budgeting, resourcing, team leadership, client relationships, and profitability — across multiple concurrent projects and disciplines.
- Led new business development and strategic growth, building an international network of specialist delivery partners.

Head of Production
2018 — 2019
INITION · London

- Senior leadership role at one of London's leading immersive technology studios, overseeing the full production department including scoping, budgeting, resourcing, and profitability.
- Built the internal rate card and quotation framework with the CFO, and led the migration from SAP to Workbook, standardising delivery workflows across the business.
- Oversaw the R&D function, evaluating emerging technologies and prototyping concepts for client proposals and retained business.

Production Manager & Global Studio Manager
2014 — 2018
Blippar · London / Amsterdam / Tokyo

- Progressed from Studio Manager to Global Project Manager, supporting rapid international expansion across studios in the UK, Amsterdam, and Japan.
- Delivered campaigns for Pepsi, Coca-Cola, Kellogg's, and the British Consulate, managing budgets, risks, and cross-regional reporting for senior leadership.
- Led the rollout of Traffic Live as the global resource management platform, improving utilisation tracking and delivery forecasting across all markets.

SELECTED CLIENTS

ASICS	Nike / NOCTA	Formula 1	HP / Ferrari
Heineken	Google	LEGO	UEFA
Edelman	Wasserman	Airbus	Cathay Pacific

References available on request